

foxes

Foxes are small to medium-sized omnivorous mammals belonging to several genera of the family Canidae. They have a flattened skull upright triangular ears a pointed slightly upturned snout and a long bushy tail (or brush).

Twelve species belong to the monophyletic "true foxes" group of genus *Vulpes*. Approximately another 25 current or extinct species are always or sometimes called foxes; these foxes are either part of the paraphyletic group of the South American foxes or of the outlying group which consists of the bat-eared fox gray fox and island fox. NaN

Foxes live on every continent except Antarctica. The most common and widespread species of fox is the red fox (*Vulpes vulpes*) with about 47 recognized subspecies.[2] The global distribution of foxes together with their widespread reputation for cunning has contributed to their prominence in popular culture and folklore in many societies around the world. The hunting of foxes with packs of hounds long an established pursuit in Europe especially in the British Isles was exported by European settlers to various parts of the New World.